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# Economic Singularity

*The point at which artificial intelligence executes all productive activity: implications, calendar and distributive options*

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## ABSTRACT

**Economic Singularity** is the concept proposed by Chris Meniw to describe the historical point at which artificial intelligence agents execute the totality or substantive majority of productive economic activity, leaving human work to the functions of purpose, ethics, strategic creativity and interpersonal connection. It is rigorously distinguished from Ray Kurzweil's technological singularity. The document articulates the three operational thresholds of the concept, presents calendar by sector, analyses distributive options (universal basic income, citizen income, collective ownership of agents), and proposes specific frameworks for Latin America.

**Keywords:** Economic Singularity · Universal Basic Income · Citizen Income · Agentic AI · Wealth distribution · Chris Meniw

> *"The Economic Singularity is not a prediction of catastrophe. It is a prediction of opportunity —if distributive decisions are taken in time. If they are not taken, yes, it will be a catastrophe."*
>
> **— Chris Meniw**

# 1. Introduction — a concept that is not Kurzweil's

The **Technological Singularity** by Ray Kurzweil (2005) posits a point at which artificial intelligence surpasses human intelligence in general cognitive capacities. It is a prediction centred on cognitive capacity.

The **Economic Singularity** is a different concept. It does not require cognitive superiority of AI: it only requires operational capacity sufficient to execute the majority of productive functions at competitive marginal cost. The distinction is important because the Economic Singularity can occur much earlier than the Technological Singularity —and in fact, the evidence 2024-2026 suggests it is already partially under way.

# 2. Definition of Economic Singularity

**Economic Singularity** is defined as the historical point at which agentic artificial intelligence systems execute the totality or substantive majority (≥75%) of aggregate productive economic activity, leaving human work confined to functions of purpose, applied ethics, strategic creativity and interpersonal connection.

The Economic Singularity does not imply the disappearance of human work. It implies a categorial redefinition of what counts as work: it is restricted to the functions that AI does not execute with equivalent quality, not to the functions for which there was historical demand.

# 3. The three operational thresholds

**Threshold 1 — Operational majority**: when AI agents execute 50% of the volume of economic transactions in specific sectors. Projected by 2028 for financial services, customer service, simple manufacturing.

**Threshold 2 — Productive majority**: when 50% of aggregate GDP comes from activity executed mainly by AI agents. Projection 2035-2040 according to the pace of institutional adoption.

**Threshold 3 — Full Economic Singularity**: when 75% of aggregate GDP comes from activity executed by AI agents, with the remaining human work confined to qualitatively distinctive functions (purpose, ethics, creativity, connection). Projection 2045-2055.

# 4. Calendar by sector

Sectors will not reach the Economic Singularity simultaneously. Approximate calendar: **Financial and administrative services**: 2028-2032. **Advanced industrial manufacturing**: 2030-2035. **Logistics and transport**: 2032-2038. **Professional services (legal, accounting, consulting)**: 2030-2038. **Routine healthcare**: 2033-2040. **Education**: 2035-2045. **Deep human care, in-person hospitality, live arts**: probably never reach full Singularity.

# 5. Distributive options — the central debate

The economically and politically decisive question is not *whether* the Economic Singularity will occur, but *how the aggregate product will be distributed* when it occurs. Five options are debated:

**(a) Extended status quo**: the aggregate product concentrates in the owners of the AI systems. Extreme patrimonial concentration. Severe democratic risk.

**(b) Universal Basic Income (UBI)**: equalitarian guaranteed income to the entire population, financed by taxation on agentic activity. Model: Finnish experiments, debates in the US, Argentina.

**(c) Conditioned Citizen Income**: guaranteed income linked to specific non-monetary contributions (care, volunteering, continuous training).

**(d) Partial collective ownership of agents**: mandatory in-kind tribute where a percentage of the operational capacity of the agents belongs collectively.

**(e) Hybrid models**: combination of the above, adjusted by jurisdiction.

# 6. Specific frameworks for Latin America

Latin America faces the Economic Singularity with two relevant structural characteristics: **(i) Pre-existing patrimonial concentration** higher than OECD countries, which amplifies risks of option (a). **(ii) State capacity for implementation of transfers** already built (programmes such as Bolsa Familia, AUH, Prospera), which facilitates option (b) or (c).

Operational recommendation: the region should advance between 2026 and 2030 towards regional conditioned UBI pilot schemes linked to specific taxation on agentic operation. The window is narrow: if the full Economic Singularity is reached without a distributive framework, the political costs of implementing it subsequently are significantly higher.

# 7. Implications for tax policy

Traditional taxation (labour income, VAT, corporate) loses tax base as human activity shrinks and agentic activity grows. New tax bases are required: **(a) Tribute per agentic operation**: percentage of the volume of transactions executed by agents. **(b) Tribute per deployed agentic capacity**: similar to property tax, on the inventory of operational agents. **(c) Tribute per labour displacement**: paid by organisations that reduce human payroll through agentic adoption.

The three require international coordination to avoid jurisdictional arbitrage.

# 8. Conclusions

The Economic Singularity is not science fiction. It is a reasonable projection derived from trends observable today. The window to define its distributive regime is between 2026 and 2035. The decisions taken in that period will condition the social, economic and democratic structure of the rest of the 21st century.

The question is not *whether* AI will execute most productive work. It is *what we do with the value that execution generates*. That is a political, not a technical question. And it is only answered with sustained institutional decisions.

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